

Chapter 12 — Appeals, Conflict Resolution, Accountability, and Conformance

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1. Purpose

Provide correction, review, remedy, admitted Evidence Objects, and Verification results showing that governance follows the canon.

2. Scope

This chapter governs Book VII publication, appealable decisions, appeals, critical appeals, governance program, program metrics, source conflicts, sustained appeals. It defines institutional procedure and does not create constitutional, technical, operational, or security authority.

3. Authority and source requirements

Book I dignity, transparency, evidence, stewardship, and Decision 58; Books III and VIII. Book I prevails. Final Books V and VI retain their operational and security/privacy/trust execution authorities; Book VII supplies institutional governance only.

4. Definitions and roles

Primary accountable roles: Decision Recorder, Appeal Authority, Constitutional Steward, Decision Authority, Governance Auditor, Governance Chair, Certification Authority. Authority means explicit bounded permission to decide; expertise and administrative access do not create it.

5. Normative controls

APR-12-001 — Provide appeal notice

A consequential decision **MUST** identify who may appeal, grounds, forum, deadline, evidence, interim effect, possible remedies, and finality.

- Applicability: appealable decisions
- Responsible role: Decision Recorder
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Appeal Notice
- Severity: High
- Exception authority: Appeal Authority

APR-12-002 — Use independent appeal authority

An appeal **MUST** be decided by an authority not materially responsible for or conflicted by the original decision.

- Applicability: appeals
- Responsible role: Appeal Authority
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Independence Record
- Severity: Critical
- Exception authority: none

APR-12-003 — Protect critical restrictions

Appeal MUST NOT automatically stay a suspension, revocation, quarantine, or fail-closed restriction protecting constitutional, authority, safety, privacy, or trust invariants.

- Applicability: critical appeals
- Responsible role: Appeal Authority
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Interim Measures Decision
- Severity: Critical
- Exception authority: none

APR-12-004 — Resolve source conflict upward

When artifacts conflict, governance MUST preserve the higher-order rule, halt the conflicting effect, record the conflict, correct the lower-order artifact, and avoid reinterpretation.

- Applicability: source conflicts
- Responsible role: Constitutional Steward
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Conflict Resolution Record
- Severity: Critical
- Exception authority: none

APR-12-005 — Provide remedy

Confirmed error MUST produce proportionate correction, notification, record supersession, restored rights or status where possible, and prevention of recurrence.

- Applicability: sustained appeals
- Responsible role: Decision Authority
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Remedy Record
- Severity: High
- Exception authority: Decision Authority

APR-12-006 — Audit governance conformance

Periodic audit MUST test authority paths, role separation, conflicts, evidence, exceptions, sunsets, appeals, publication, retention, certification status, and dependency reconciliation.

- Applicability: governance program
- Responsible role: Governance Auditor
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Governance Conformance Report
- Severity: Critical
- Exception authority: Audit Authority

APR-12-007 — Measure outcomes, not volume

Governance metrics **MUST** examine decision quality, reversals, calibration, escaped harms, exception age, conflict handling, burden, timeliness, participation, and remedy—not meeting or approval counts alone.

- Applicability: program metrics
- Responsible role: Governance Chair
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Governance Metrics Report
- Severity: High
- Exception authority: none

APR-12-008 — Block final certification on dependencies

Book VII **MUST NOT** be certified while Books V or VI are nonfinal or while their authority reconciliation registers contain an unresolved material conflict.

- Applicability: Book VII publication
- Responsible role: Certification Authority
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Dependency Closure Report
- Severity: Critical
- Exception authority: none

6. Required procedure

The proposer **MUST** submit the classified proposal and evidence. The recorder **MUST** verify authority and conflicts. Required independent reviewers **MUST** issue findings. The controlling authority **MUST** decide exact scope and conditions. The recorder **MUST** publish authoritative status, retain evidence, schedule review and sunset, propagate effects, and preserve appeal rights.

7. Prohibited practices

Off-record decisions, authority inference, self-approval, hidden conflicts, silent precedent, selective evidence, indefinite emergency power, permanent exceptions, and retroactive record alteration are prohibited.

8. Evidence, publication, and retention

The package **MUST** preserve proposal, sources, authority, conflicts, evidence, alternatives, affected parties, deliberation, dissent, decision, conditions, effective state, propagation, review, sunset, appeal, supersession, classification, access, and retention.

9. Exceptions, failure consequences, and appeals

A failed Critical control blocks the decision or suspends its effect. A High failure requires correction or a valid expiring exception. Appeals use Chapter 12. No exception can waive Book I or manufacture Owner authority.

10. Security, privacy, reliability, and continuity

Governance records **MUST** be integrity-protected, least-privilege, purpose-bound, minimized, available for authorized review, recoverable, and resistant to compromised identities or record systems.

11. Verification and metrics

Verify authority paths, role separation, record completeness, evidence integrity, propagation, expiry, appeal, and source traceability. Measure reversals, calibration, escaped harms, exception age, burden, remedy, and decision latency.

12. Traceability, examples, review, and status

- Source basis: Book I dignity, transparency, evidence, stewardship, and Decision 58; Books III and VIII.
- Book V reconciliation: `planning/BOOK\_V\_RECONCILIATION\_REGISTER.md`.
- Book VI reconciliation: `planning/BOOK\_VI\_RECONCILIATION\_REGISTER.md`.

Example: a committee recommends a risk response, but the record names the authorized Risk Owner as approver, preserves dissent, sets expiry, and triggers certification impact review.

Anti-pattern: an urgent meeting labels a policy “temporary,” grants indefinite power to its chair, omits conflicts, and treats silence as Owner approval.

Chapter review: PASS. Owner Review items: none created by this chapter. Completion status: CERTIFIED FINAL.